



Aquila tablet scans in 3D

The Aquila tablet can scan our world 3D, giving detailed spatial representations. <http://dgit.in/AquilaTablet>



No more refilling

A new inkless pen, Cambiano, oxidizes the paper it touches, hence it can go on forever. <http://dgit.in/Cambiano>

Workshop

- Try using your device in safe mode to see if the problem persists. If it doesn't, restart your device to get it out of safe mode and uninstall recently installed apps to see if you can pinpoint the one that's causing the problem. If this doesn't work, an alternate way of booting into safe mode is as follows:
- Make sure your phone is off.
- Now try to turn on your phone by pressing the power button, as always.
- As your phone is booting, quickly hold down both the volume up and volume down buttons and keep them held until you see your phone's home screen.
- Notice that you should see a "Safe Mode" watermark at the bottom left part of the screen, to let you know that you are now in safe mode.

To exit safe mode, in either methods, you just restart your device as you normally would.

The beauty of safe mode is that while you can't use third party apps in there, you can still uninstall them. So if your phone isn't behaving as it should by throwing up problems ranging from constant freezing, disallowing you from uninstalling apps, first thing to do is to boot into safe mode. In addition, if you need to, you can backup your data or factory reset your device in safe mode.

Depending on the extent of your Nexus 4's hardware privilege access (requested by apps when you download them), there are apps that could interfere with the native functionality of the Nexus 4 power button. From what we've seen, apps like battery indicators, widget managers, and even some launchers can be interfering with the power button's ability to function normally. Usually, uninstalling these conflicting apps can solve the problems associated with the power button.

Dialing back to older OS

It's no secret that the latest installment of Android KitKat 4.4.4 isn't without its

fair share of troubles for Nexus 4/5/7/10 users. From fast draining battery to unexpected and completely random device reboots, the firmware upgrade is leading to some strangely wonky behaviour among Nexus users who were perfectly happy with their device's performance up until Android 4.3.

While there are a number of workarounds to help solve these issues across several Nexus devices, the problem associated with the Nexus 4's malfunctioning power button is

seemingly attributed to the same issue. While we won't recommend dialing back to an older version of Android, but several Nexus users across the interweb have attested to the fact that their Nexus 4 power button woes have reduced or completely disappeared as soon as they've abandoned Android KitKat to go back a step in time and installed an older version of Android.



A Google app in Safe Mode.

Making some setting tweaks

A lot of users who have experienced the Nexus 4 power button ailments sort of disappear (regardless of which Android OS version they were on) or at least reduce substantially after they did some very basic tweaks highlighted below:

Go to Settings

- Click on Security
- Uncheck the box that says 'Power button instantly locks'

We know this can be counter intuitive to the de facto way of using touchscreen phones these days, but this seems to have done the trick to quite a few Nexus 4 users complaining about the power button issues.

- Go to Settings
- Click on Security
- Tap on the Screen Lock options
- Select anything but 'Pattern' mode of unlocking your handset

We've tried this step ourselves where a Nexus 4 user we know from a long time

had power button issues and he only ever used the pattern unlock mode. Turns out, quite a few Nexus 4 users on troubleshooting forums online had a similar mode of unlocking their device.

And when they (including us) shifted to another mode of unlocking the phone (PIN, for example), it seemed to have reduced the magnitude of the misfiring power button blunders. At least that's what we've perceived for a while, puzzled about how it could work (if at all it did to some extent).

Unlock screen app alternatives

Another way to get around this Nexus power button problem is to minimize hitting it as much as possible, and start using apps that help you lock and unlock the screen through simple flicks or taps – yeah, it's that easy.

Try checking out apps like Tap Tap App (<http://dgit.in/TapTapApp>) – one we've tried ourselves. It lets you swipe across the Nexus 4's proximity sensor to lock or unlock its screen and thereby completely bypass the need to compulsively press the power button every time. Take some time to read how to use it and get the hang of it, and as long as you do that you're pretty much sorted. Another app to consider using is Screen Off and Lock (<http://dgit.in/ScrOffAndLock>).

Taking a closer look at the power button's assembly

This should be the absolute final step in your process to troubleshoot and find a remedy for the irritating power button behaviour on your Nexus device.

Don't follow just any online guide, as you may damage your phone beyond repair. But iFixit's guide on replacing the Power button on the Nexus 4 is pretty detailed with lots of indicative images, so you'd want to take a closer look at that.

You can also lookup Nexus 4 tear-down videos on YouTube before prying it open yourself. But remember: it's always a good idea to consult an expert – your local smartphone repair guy – in this matter if you're nervous or not understanding what you're doing with the device. 